

Vi can easily move around or within (or even between) files. With the array of commands at your disposal, your usage of the arrow key reduces significantly.

To just start using vi, try and create a new file and type something in just to get accustomed to it. Go to the command prompt and type in “*vi digit*” and press *[Enter]*, where “*digit*” is the name of the file you are creating, provided there is no other file by the name “*digit*.” If there is, the vi editor will simply open that file.

The vi editor is now open, and you can type in something. To exit, press *[Esc]* to return to the command prompt, and then type “ZZ” and press *[Enter]* (you can also type “:wq”) to save your work and exit. Now you know the most basic of any application—open and close. Let us now see some of the things you can do in between those operations.

To use commands in vi, just press *[Esc]*, which will get you to the command mode. If you need to get back to text enter mode, just press *[Insert]*. We said one of the best things of vi is its navigation: in the command mode, just press *[E]* to go to the end of the word, *[K]* to go to the previous line, and “\$” to move to the end of line. There are several such commands to move around the text in the file:

*[H]*: Move cursor one character to left

*[J]*: move cursor one line down

*[K]*: move cursor one line up

*[L]*: move cursor one character to right

*[W]*: move cursor one word to right

*[B]*: move cursor one word to left

*[O]*: move cursor to beginning of line

\$: move cursor to end of line

*[N]* + *[G]*: move cursor to line n

*[Ctrl]* + *[F]*: Scroll forward one screen

*[Ctrl]* + *[B]*: Scroll backward one screen

*[I]*: Insert to left of current cursor position (end with *[Esc]*)